PRODUCT JOURNEY · HIGHER EDUCATION

HE Enrolment Journey
Two paths, one platform

From setting up curriculum to a confirmed student enrolment — the end-to-end journey through the student management system, whether the wizard is driven by an administrator or by the student themselves.

Built by the **Dynamite Squad** · ReadyTech
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Introduction

Every HE student ends up in the same place — a confirmed set of Subject Offerings tied to Academic Periods, financial liability created, TCSI records prepared. But two very different journeys can get them there: an **administrator** can drive the whole process from the student management system (SMS), or the **student** can drive it themselves from the Student Portal.

Under the surface, both journeys share the same backend services, the same requisite engine, and the same six validation gates. What differs is **who is allowed to override what**, and how much has to be in place before the front door even opens.

🕐

Less admin effort

Routine subject enrolments move to the student — freeing staff for the exceptions that genuinely need them.

🎓

Student autonomy

Students pick their electives and shape their study plan themselves, from any device, whenever the enrolment window is open.

🛡️

Rules always enforced

Requisites, program structure and enrolment windows are checked live. Unlike admins, students can never override them.

🔀

Two paths, one engine

Admin and self-enrol go through the same validation engine. One source of truth, whether staff or students drive the wizard.

My role

On the Dynamite Squad I worked across HE enrolment in three roles: shaping how the two enrolment paths fit together, documenting the rules behind them, and testing them end to end. This walkthrough is built from that work.

PRODUCT MANAGER

Positioned self-enrolment alongside admin-led enrolment

- Defined the value: routine enrolments move to students, while staff keep override authority for the exceptions.
- Shaped an opt-in rollout per provider (switches, enrolment pattern and enrolment dates), so institutions adopt when they're ready.
- Turned testing findings into backlog improvements, such as duplicate-enrolment alerts and a clearer requisite dialog when several subjects are affected.
- Presented the capability to clients and internal teams through walkthroughs like this one.

What I produced: Product walkthroughs · Backlog input · Client demos

BUSINESS ANALYST

Mapped two journeys onto one rules engine

- Documented the end-to-end flow, from curriculum setup in Curriculum Builder to a confirmed enrolment, for both paths.
- Captured the six validation gates, and which two administrators can override.
- Defined eligibility for each self-enrolment scope (Year, Period, Adjust) and the drop-window rules.
- Wrote the HE domain reference used by the squad, covering Curriculum Builder, self-enrolment, CSP clusters and SA-HELP.

What I produced: Journey maps · Rules matrix · Domain reference

QUALITY & TESTING

Tested both paths end to end

- Tested enrolment end to end: subject selection, requisites, eligibility, multi-period confirm and rollback, and financial liability.
- Tested withdrawal before and after the census date, and drop-only mode once the enrolment window has closed.
- Built HE regression coverage into the squad's AI QA agent, alongside Playwright specs for curriculum migration and credit-point handling.
- Kept the squad's QA knowledge base current, with 30+ updates on HE features in 2026.

What I produced: Test scenarios · Playwright regression · QA knowledge base

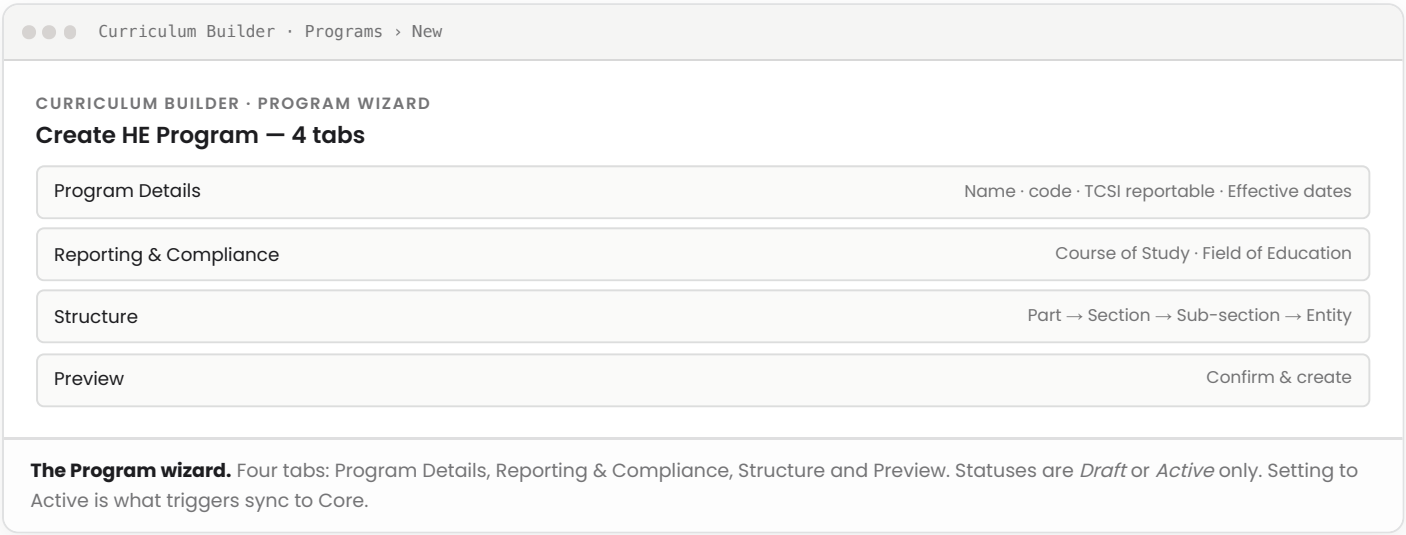
2	6	3	30+
enrolment paths, one engine	validation gates documented	self-enrolment scopes	HE knowledge-base updates

1 Setup — before either wizard can open

Everything the student — or their administrator — experiences is controlled upstream on **the student management system** and **Curriculum Builder**. Three layers matter: the curriculum has to exist, the course has to be structured, and (for self-enrol only) the right switches have to be flipped.

a. Curriculum Builder — the source of truth

Curriculum Builder (CB) is a separate app reached through Core at *Administration → Curriculum → Curriculum Builder*. HE Programs, Subjects, versions and requisites all live here. Setting a Program or Subject Version to **Active** is what triggers the one-way sync from CB to Core. Only Active items sync.

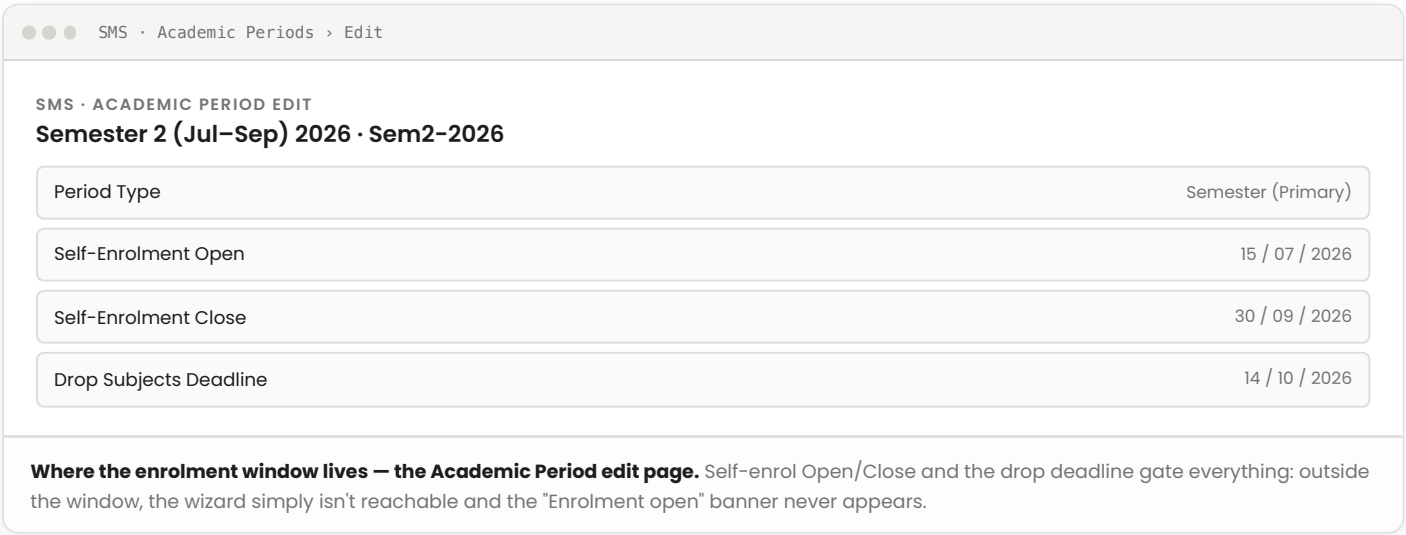


The Program wizard. Four tabs: Program Details, Reporting & Compliance, Structure and Preview. Statuses are *Draft* or *Active* only. Setting to Active is what triggers sync to Core.

> **CB is where HE lives.** The SMS's core engine is VET-focused and can't natively express HE structures — programs, subjects, versioning, requisites, structured groups. CB fills that gap and hands the results to the SMS automatically.

b. The SMS — calendars, offerings, course, student

Once CB has synced, everything else is built in Core: Academic Periods with Period Types (one must be marked **Primary**), Subject Offerings that tie a synced subject version to a period + location + attendance mode, the HE Course itself, and the student enrolment against the course. Any period the program doesn't include is invisible to the wizard.



Where the enrolment window lives — the Academic Period edit page. Self-enrol Open/Close and the drop deadline gate everything: outside the window, the wizard simply isn't reachable and the "Enrolment open" banner never appears.

c. Feature flags & provider settings *(self-enrol only)*

The admin path skips this section entirely — Manage Enrolment appears the moment an HE enrolment exists. Self-enrol needs the full stack of flags in place, plus a "yearly" enrolment pattern for year-scope and non-null self-enrolment dates on the primary Academic Period.



Portal flag chain

Four portal switches, from the base Student Portal up to Higher Ed and finally HE Self-Enrolment. All four must be on.



Dev flags

Curriculum Engine and *Curriculum Builder* under Development feature flags — superuser only. Powers requisite & program-structure validation.



Provider setting

HE Self-Enrolment is also a provider-level preference, separate from the feature flags. If it is off, the wizard is unreachable.



Pattern & dates

Subject Enrolment Pattern = *Yearly* unlocks year-scope. Primary AP needs non-null open & close dates.

💡 **The setup story in one line:** curriculum in CB, calendar in Core, and (if self-enrol) flags and dates. Miss any one and the wizard stays closed.

2 Login & entry points

Two front doors, two different actors — but both lead to the same wizard engine. The administrator signs into the SMS; the student signs into the Student Portal. Each surface only shows the enrolment action when the platform confirms it's allowed.

SMS · Student › Enrolments — Admin

SMS · STUDENT ENROLMENT

Enrolment · HE Program (Semester 2, 2026)

Manage Enrolment	HE only — hidden on VET
Enrol Student	→ Wizard opens for the period

The admin entry. Manage Enrolment appears only on HE enrolments. Each academic period on the enrolment shows an "Enrol Student" action that opens the wizard scoped to that period.

Student Portal · Enrolments — Student

STUDENT PORTAL · ENROLMENTS

HE Program · Enrolment open

Enrol for Semester 2 — closes 30/09/2026	Start
Enrol for Semester 3 — opens 01/10/2026	Not yet open

The student entry. The Enrol action shows only when the platform reports at least one available enrolment scope and an open enrolment window. Otherwise the enrolment is visible but not actionable.

🔐 **Credentials, one place.** Student logins are provisioned in the SMS the moment a student record is created. Admins log in with their staff credentials — the same sign-in service that also authenticates Curriculum Builder.

3 The fork — where the two journeys diverge

Same enrolment, same offerings, same engine. From here the journey shape depends entirely on who is driving.

ADMIN PATH

Administrator drives

Staff at the institution — admissions or student services — running the enrolment inside the SMS.

- → Opens Manage Enrolment on the student record
- → Sees offerings without portal-flag gating
- → **Can override** Requisites & Standard Load with a reason
- → Handles exceptions (backdated enrolments, waivers)

— FORK —

STUDENT PATH

Student drives

The student themselves, from the Student Portal, inside the guardrails their institution set up in advance.

- → Sees the Enrol action when the window is open
- → One of three wizard scopes: *Year*, *Period*, or *Adjust*
- → **Cannot override** any validation — hard gates for all
- → Guided, mobile-friendly, saveable mid-flow

4 The admin-led journey

Five steps from Manage Enrolment to a confirmed enrolment. The wizard runs inside the SMS; the admin can override two gates on the student's behalf.

Manage Enrolment → Enrol Student → Select offerings → Review & validate → Confirm

1 **Open Manage Enrolment**

From the student's Enrolment tab in the SMS. HE-only surface — VET students don't see it.

2 **Click Enrol Student against a period**

Each academic period on the enrolment shows an Enrol action. Clicking opens the wizard scoped to that period.

3 **Select offerings**

Pick the Subject Offerings for the period. The pool matches what a self-enrolling student would see — but the admin isn't gated by portal flags.

4 **Review & validate**

The system runs the six validation checks (§6). Two — Requisites and Standard Load — can be overridden here with a captured reason.

5 **Confirm**

Multi-period confirms are atomic — a failure in one AP rolls back all of them. On success, financial liability is created and TCSI records are updated.

🔑 **What the admin has that the student doesn't:** override authority on *Requisites* and *Standard Load*. Every other gate — Program rules, Offering status, Calendar constraints, Duplicate prevention — is hard for both paths.

5 The student self-enrolment journey

A guided wizard the student drives themselves, in one of three scopes chosen by URL — not a dropdown. Each scope has its own eligibility rules; if they aren't met, that wizard isn't available.

Login → Dashboard / Enrolments → **Enrol** → Wizard → Add subjects → Review → **Confirm**

a. Three scopes, one wizard

Which wizard the student gets depends on the institution's Subject Enrolment Pattern and what they're doing (fresh enrolment vs. modifying an existing one).

Year-scope

Multi-period across a calendar year. Requires the *Yearly* enrolment pattern and a Primary academic period whose close date is still ahead.

Period-scope

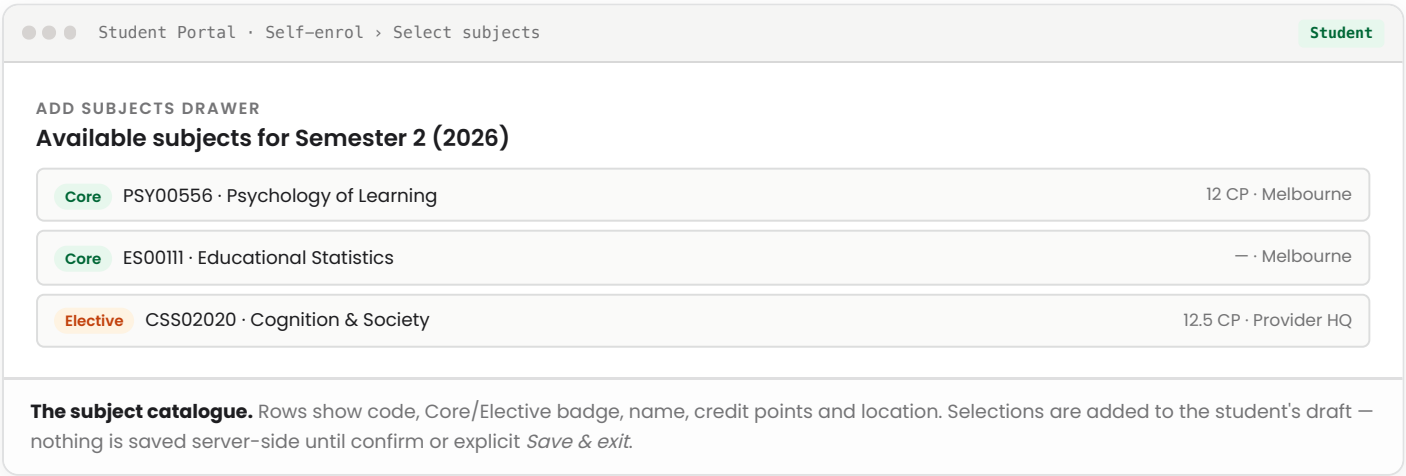
A single academic period. The period must be Primary, with both self-enrolment dates set.

Adjust-scope

Modify an existing enrolment — add or drop. Available while either the close date or the drop deadline is still ahead.

b. Choosing subjects — the drawer

Clicking **Add subjects** opens a side drawer with every offering available to this student, in this period, in their program. Search as you type, and filter by Core or Elective. Search and filter survive a page reload.



The subject catalogue. Rows show code, Core/Elective badge, name, credit points and location. Selections are added to the student's draft — nothing is saved server-side until confirm or explicit *Save & exit*.

c. Review page

A read-only summary of the student's draft picks, grouped by academic period. Per-period **StudyLoadAlert** shows what percentage of the standard load the draft represents. No mutation controls — just *Back*, *Confirm*, and *Save & exit*.

> ⚠️ **Multi-AP atomicity.** A single failure in any academic period rolls back the entire confirm. If a student had 3 subjects across 2 APs and one requisite check fails, none of the enrolments land. Design test cases with that in mind.

d. Save & resume

Save & exit saves the draft to the server, so the student can pick up exactly where they left off, from any device. Note: **hard refresh wipes drafts** because wizard state is session-only in the browser until *Save & exit* is used.

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6 Validation gates

Six checks stand between "selected" and "enrolled". Four are hard on both paths. Two soften for administrators. And unlike admin-led enrolment, **there is no student override**.

Gate	What it checks	Admin-led	Self-enrol
Program rules	Every subject must belong to the student's program structure. Failure returns 422.	Hard	Hard
Offering status	Offering must be `Active` with `Allow Enrolments = Yes`.	Hard	Hard
Calendar constraints	Today must sit inside every relevant date window — offering, period, self-enrol dates on the primary AP.	Hard	Hard
Duplicate prevention	No re-enrolling in the same offering; no different offering of an already-completed or already-enrolled subject.	Hard	Hard
Requisite rules	Pre, co, concurrent pre, anti, equivalent. Real CB evaluation per version, with AND/OR + score/grade/credit conditions.	Overridable	Hard
Standard load	Total credit points vs the period's standard load. Admin: gate. Student: shown as an informational alert only.	Overridable	Info only

> 💡 **Worth calling out to clients:** validation is done by the same curriculum engine that powers admin-led enrolment — one source of truth for rules, whether staff or students drive the process.

- **Duplicate-enrolment alerts**

Two messages can appear on the review page: "Subject already completed" and "Subject already added — you've selected a different offering". Both are non-actionable — no *+Add*, no dialog. The student has to remove and re-pick.

7 Confirm — what actually happens

The moment the student or admin clicks the button, five things happen server-side. Both journeys share the same transaction boundary, the same atomicity guarantee, and the same reporting hooks.

1. **Requisites re-evaluated**
   Not trusted from the review page — requisites are checked again on the server, so a stale draft can't slip through.
2. **Program-rules pass repeated**
   Ensures a subject wasn't removed from the program structure between selection and confirm.
3. **Enrolment records written**
   One enrolment record per subject, plus academic-period enrolment records for any new periods.
4. **Financial liability created**
   Tuition fees, plus the student services and amenities fee (SSAF) where SA-HELP applies.
5. **TCSI records prepared**
   Reporting hooks fire so the enrolment appears in the next TCSI submission cycle.

> 🔒 **Safe by design:** confirms are protected against double-submission, and if any rule fails at the last moment (e.g. a requisite), the whole submission rolls back — a student can never end up half-enrolled.

8 Adjust, drop, withdraw

Confirming isn't the end of the journey. Three ways to reverse or amend, each with its own window and its own owner.

a. Student-driven adjust

The adjust-scope wizard lets the student add or drop within an open window. Every drop is checked against the drop window. If the enrolment close date has passed but the drop deadline is still open, the wizard loads in **drop-only** mode.

Adjust your subjects → Drop / add → Review → Subjects adjusted

b. Admin withdrawal

Withdrawal is admin-only, from the Manage Enrolment page. Beyond removing the enrolment, it handles the downstream cleanup:



Financial liability

Fee refund or write-off, depending on timing relative to the census date.



Outcome assignment

Withdrawn subjects get the correct outcome code (WD, WF, etc.) recorded against the enrolment.



TCSI reporting

The withdrawal event is prepared for the next TCSI submission — no re-keying required.



What the student can't do. A student cannot withdraw themselves. Adjust-scope handles subject-level drops during the drop window; anything beyond that — leaving a program, cancelling an academic period — is admin territory.

Summary

The whole HE enrolment story, in one view — capabilities the platform delivers across both journeys.

Capability	What it means for the institution
Two enrolment paths	Admin-led (Manage Enrolment in the SMS) and student-led (Student Portal). Same engine, different front door, different override authority.
Curriculum in one place	Programs, subjects, versions and requisites live in Curriculum Builder. A single "Set to Active" click syncs them to Core.
Three self-enrol scopes	**Year** (all periods in a calendar year), **Period** (one semester), **Adjust** (modify existing). URL-driven, gated by pattern + primary AP dates.
Six validation gates	Program rules · Offering status · Calendar constraints · Duplicate prevention · Requisite rules · Standard load. Four hard, two admin-overridable.
Real-time guardrails	Requisite evaluation, program-structure validation and study-load visibility as the student selects — with no student override.
Save & resume	Wizard state persists across sessions and devices. Students can start on laptop, finish on phone.
Atomic confirms	Multi-period confirms are all-or-nothing. Server-side re-evaluation of requisites at commit time. No half-enrolled students.
Post-enrolment mechanics	Student adjust (add/drop) within the window, admin withdrawal with financial & TCSI cleanup handled automatically.
Controlled rollout	Self-enrol is switched per provider via feature flags + provider setting — institutions opt in when they're ready.

🚀 **The takeaway:** students get a modern, consumer-grade enrolment experience; institutions keep complete control of the rules; and staff get their time back — while admin-led enrolment stays available for every exception that needs a human decision.